



HAMBURG RACE PREVIEW

Race Analysis · July 9 – 12, 2026

USA Triathlon High Performance

Race Week Schedule

Hamburg



July 9 – 12, 2026 • Rathausmarkt / Binnenalster, Hamburg, Germany (CEST, UTC+2)

Fri • July 10	
Familiarization & Briefing	
TBD	Course familiarization — swim, bike, run circuits
TBD	★ Mandatory Elite athlete briefing
TBD	Race package distribution

Sat • July 11	
ELITE SPRINT RACE DAY	
11:30 – 12:45	Elite Men — athletes' lounge check-in + warm-up
12:15 – 13:00	Elite Men — swim warm-up + transition check
13:10	Elite Men — athletes' introduction
13:15	★ ELITE MEN START
~14:06	Elite Men — projected finish
14:15	Elite Men medals ceremony
13:45 – 14:45	Elite Women — athletes' lounge check-in + warm-up
14:15 – 14:55	Elite Women — swim warm-up + transition check
14:50	Elite Women — athletes' introduction
15:00	★ ELITE WOMEN START
~15:55	Elite Women — projected finish
16:05	Elite Women medals ceremony
Evening	Mixed Relay team declaration

Sun • July 12	
Mixed Relay Day	
TBD	Mixed Relay team managers' meeting
17:30	★ MIXED RELAY START
~18:45	Mixed Relay projected finish
Post-finish	Mixed Relay medals ceremony

Times Rathausmarkt / Binnenalster, Hamburg, Germany (CEST, UTC+2). Schedule confirmed from World Triathlon race-info page / athlete guide; subject to organiser updates.



HAMBURG

WTCS Hamburg is one of the sport's flagship city-center races, set in the heart of Hamburg along the Binnenalster and the historic Rathausmarkt. This is the first year that the city is hosting a Para Series event.

COURSE FEATURES

- Sheltered 750 m Binnenalster swim. Typically flat fresh water. Pontoon start and likely a non-wetsuit swim.
- 2 × 8.4 km urban bike (17.8 km). Flat but highly technical course with multiple turns.
- 3 × 1.8 km flat run through city-center streets. Despite some cobblestone sections this is typically a fast run that comes down to a late surge.
- Sunday 13:45 Start Time

COURSE AT A GLANCE

Swim:	750 m – 1 lap
Bike:	17.8 km – 2 laps × 8.4 km
Run:	5.4 km – 3 laps × 1.8 km
Format:	Sprint Triathlon
Bike Laps:	2
Run Laps:	3

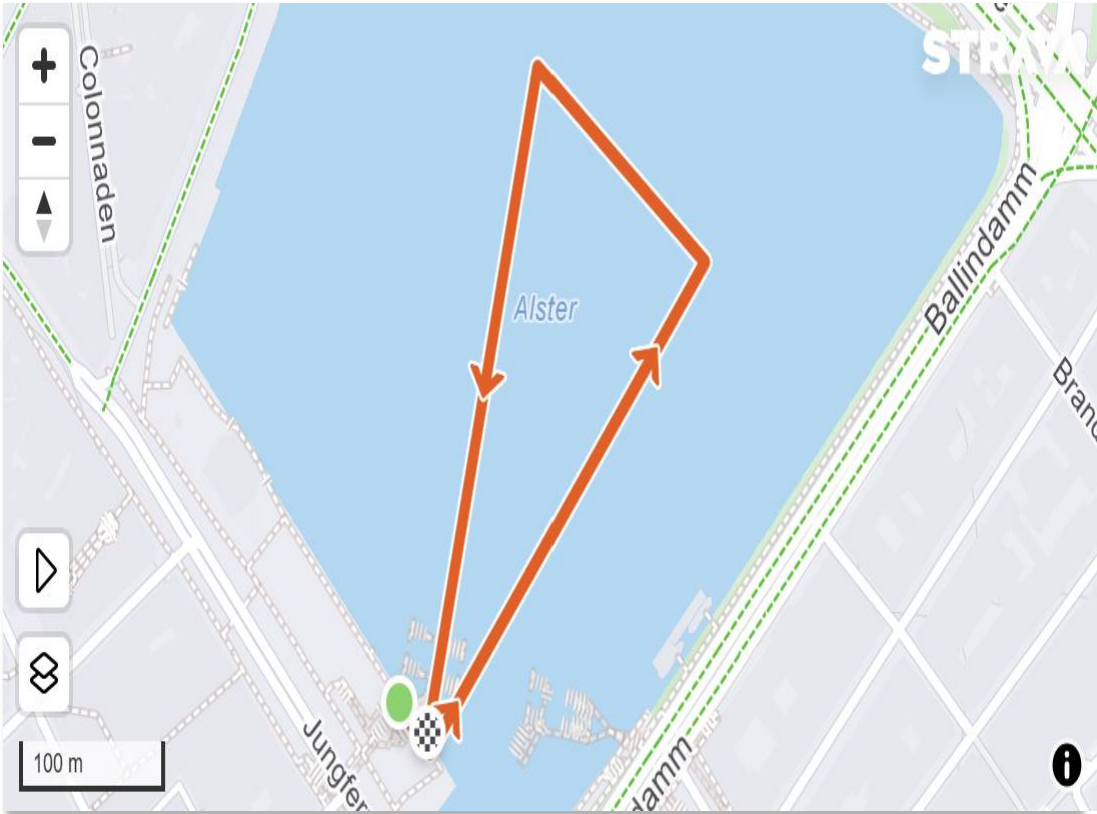
QUICK LINKS

Current Race Info:

[Race Info | 2026 World Triathlon Championship Series Hamburg](#)

Swim Course Profile

Hamburg



Source: World Triathlon race info — 2026 WTCS Hamburg

750 m • single lap

Sheltered urban lake — fresh water, calm conditions

Distance 750 m	Body of Water River	Start Pontoon start
Water Temp 18.0–22.0 °C	Wetsuit N/A	Lap Count 1

Tactical Notes

- Single 750 m loop with a pontoon start into the Alster canal.
- Fresh water lake in city center. Typically calm conditions
- July morning water mid-to-high teens Celsius.
- Finish in same starting location

Bike Course Profile

Hamburg



Source: World Triathlon race info — 2026 WTCS Hamburg

17.8 km • 2 × 8.4 km loops?

Closed urban circuit — Rathausmarkt, Alsterufer, Jungfernstieg

Elevation / Lap

41 m / lap

Total Climb

?ft

Avg Grade

~0-1%

Max Climb Grade

7%

Wind

City-center setting

Loops

NA

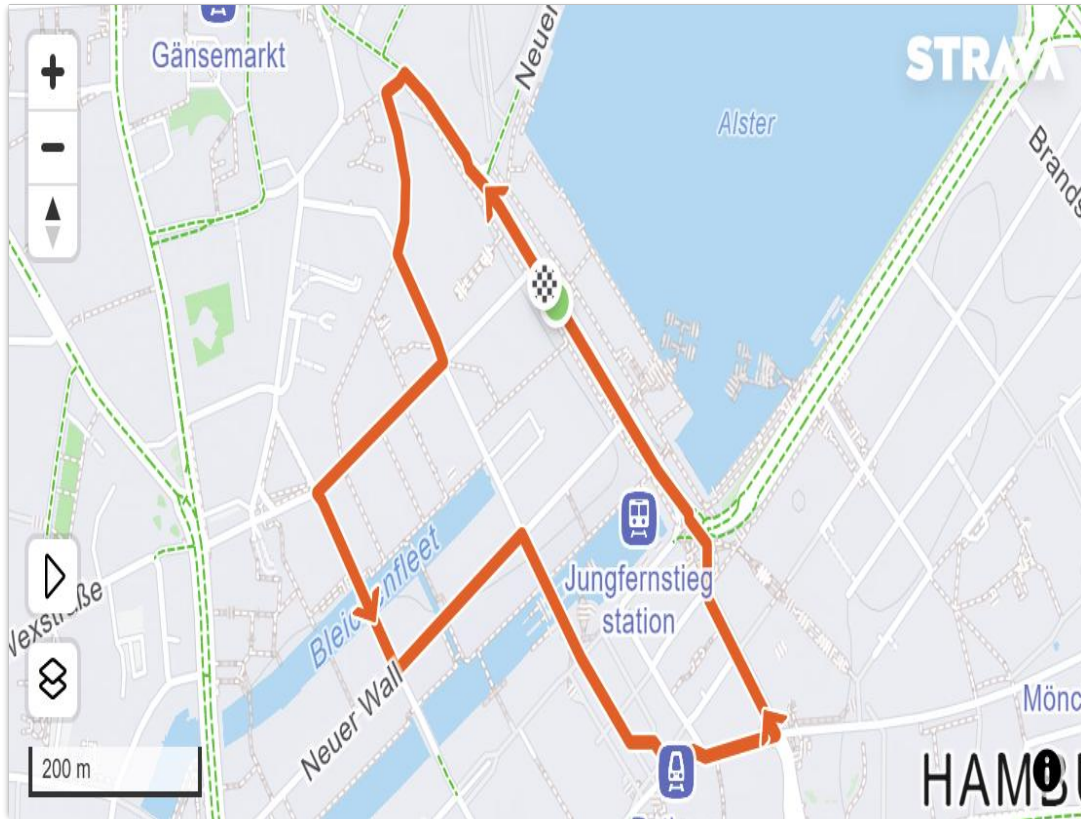
Tactical Implications

- Hamburg's city center bike represents one of the most technical WTCS bike courses. Pancake-flat throughout, but high-frequency turns reward bike-handling skills alongside power.
- Cobblestone sections add additional complexity

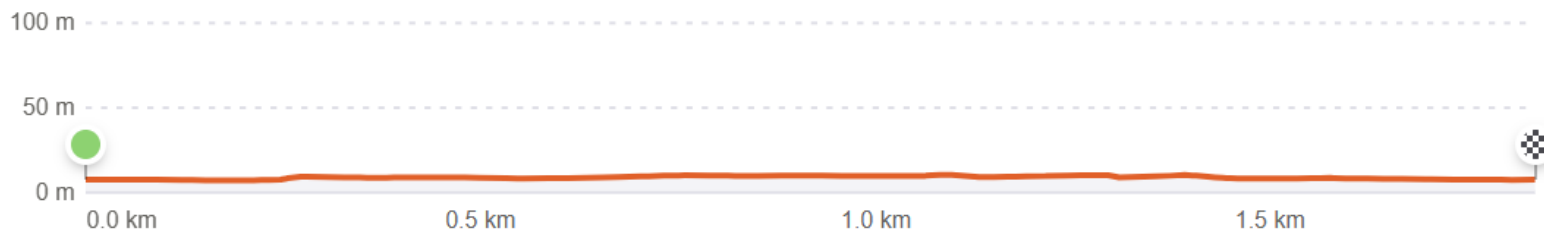


Run Course Profile

Hamburg



Source: World Triathlon race info — 2026 WTCS Hamburg



5.0 km • 3? × 1.8 km

Closed urban — Rathausmarkt, Alsterarkaden, city hall precinct

Distance

5.0 km

Lap Structure

3 X 1.8 km

Total Climb

6 m

Avg Grade

~0-1%

Max ▲ / ▼

+ 1.8%

Heat Risk

LOW-MODERATE

Tactical Notes

- 3 X 1.8 km laps through Hamburg's historic city center offers a flat, fast, and most importantly a spectator-dense course
- Cobblestone sections add additional terrain from typically road surfaces.
- July Hamburg averages ~22 °C, manageable but warm

Travel & Arrival Load

Denver, CO → Hamburg race week



Core travel read

Denver → Hamburg requires one or two stops. Typical routes connect through London (LHR), Amsterdam (AMS), Frankfurt (FRA), or Paris (CDG) before the short connection into Hamburg (HAM). Lufthansa and United operate the best options from DEN. CEST (UTC+2) is 8 hours ahead of MDT. Hamburg Airport (HAM) is 10 km from the city center. Taxi/rideshare ~20 min, S-Bahn line S1 links the airport to the Hauptbahnhof in ~25 min. Most WTCS hotels sit within 1–2 km of the Alster.

Primary route

DEN → HAM

1–2 stops

Flight time

~14–16h

Including layover

Time zones

+8h

CEST ahead of MDT

Airport Transfer

HAM → City Center

S-Bahn S1 ~25 min or taxi ~20 min

Transfer Distance

~10 km

HAM Airport to Binnenalster

Host Hotel / Official Accommodation

- Historic WTCS host hotels cluster along the Außenalster and inner city: Radisson Blu, Fairmont Hotel Vier Jahreszeiten, and NH Hotels are common LOC choices.
- Binnenalster / Rathausmarkt area gives walking distance to transition. No shuttle needed for pre-race check-in or familiarization.
- City centre parking is limited and expensive. most athletes walk or use S-Bahn from the hotel to the venue.

Food / Grocery Options Near Hotel + Venue

- Best stock-up: REWE, Edeka, or Aldi branches within 10 min walk of the Binnenalster area; Hamburger Str / Mönckebergstraße corridor has most options.
- Quick basics: dm (pharmacy), Starbucks, Backwerk, and bakeries throughout the Rathausmarkt pedestrian zone.
- Athlete-friendly meals: Zum Alten Rathaus, Block House (Hamburg chain), and Superkitchen near the Alster area.

Environmental Risk Profile

Hamburg



RACE-DAY WEATHER (08:00–11:00 local)						AIR QUALITY (Open-Meteo archive)				
Year	Date	Air Temp	Humidity	Wind km/h	Precip mm	Year	PM2.5	EU AQI	UV Index	Risk
2018	Jul 14	21	67%	11	0.0	2018	2.5	19	—	Good
2019	Jul 06	15.0°*	87%	16	1.1	2019	6.2	14	—	Good
2020	Sep 05	13.8°*	94%	14	—	2020	4.8	17	—	Good
2021	Sep 18	15.5°*	84%	10	0.0	2021	3.8	10	—	Good
2022	Jul 09	23.4	81%	—	0.1	2022	4.7	15	—	Good
2023	Jul 15	24.4°*	54%	—	0.0	2023	6.5	35	2.8	Fair
2024	Jul 13	18.9	79%	22	0.0	2024	3.6	21	1.2	Fair
2025	Jul 12	23.6	76%	14	0.2	2025	5.7	21	1.5	Fair

HEALTH & WATER QUALITY RISK FACTORS

- Race Report Here -> [Water Quality | 2026 World Triathlon Championship Series Hamburg](#)

Weather and AQ data: Open-Meteo historical archive (archive-api.open-meteo.com). EU AQI: Good ≤20, Fair ≤40, Moderate ≤60, Poor ≤80, Very Poor >80.